

RUI COUTO, PH.D.

Lead Product Designer | AI Agents, Systems Architecture & Platform Experience

Braga, Portugal • ruicoutoux.github.io/portfolio • linkedin.com/in/rmscouto

SUMMARY

Lead Product Designer and Directly Responsible Individual (DRI) with **7+ years of experience** shaping complex enterprise platforms, AI-assisted workflows, and identity systems. Bridging software engineering architecture, product strategy, and user experience, I specialize in turning complex technical abstractions and agentic capabilities into intuitive, trusted, and configurable products. Ph.D. in Computer Science with a strong track record of establishing scalable design patterns, leading cross-functional teams, and driving measurable customer adoption across enterprise lines.

CORE COMPETENCIES

AI & Automation: Agentic Workflows, Human-in-the-Loop, Trust & Guardrails, AI Feedback Synthesis	Product & Systems: Enterprise SaaS, System Architecture, Reusable Patterns, Platform Extensibility
Leadership & Strategy: DRI Ownership, Strategic Alignment (PM, Eng, Research), Product Vision	Technical Depth: Software Engineering Background, Public APIs & RBAC, Multi-Tenant Architecture

KEY IMPACT & ACHIEVEMENTS

- AI Discovery Acceleration:** Pitched and built an internal AI-powered customer feedback synthesizer, reducing discovery analysis cycles across global R&D teams.
- Enterprise Unblocking:** Redesigned external IdP (OIDC/SAML) identity integration, directly unblocking major enterprise sales pipelines and reducing support tickets.
- R&D Performance Recognition:** Awarded OutSystems Top Performer Award (Top 1% across global R&D) and Hackathon Winner for AI experimental tooling.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

OutSystems

Mar 2020 – Present | Remote (Portugal)

Lead UX Product Designer & DRI

- Design Leadership & DRI Ownership:** Lead end-to-end UX strategy, discovery, and execution across enterprise value streams (Identity & ALM), driving cross-functional alignment across Product Management, Architecture, and Engineering.
- Enterprise Architecture & Governance:** Spearheaded the UX and system design for custom delivery pipelines across distinct enterprise business lines, mapping complex technical constraints into seamless user configurations.
- AI Orchestration & Internal Tools:** Pitched, architected, and designed an internal AI-driven feedback synthesizer. Democratized user signals across R&D, accelerating discovery synthesis, data analysis, and product iteration loops.
- Platform Extensibility & Security:** Led the UX architecture for public API integrations, granular RBAC permissions, and credentials management, enabling third-party automation and driving platform usage.
- Customer Alignment & Community:** Direct engagement with enterprise customers, MVPs, and internal stakeholders to validate architectural decisions, leading workshops and sessions at events like OutSystems ONE (Amsterdam).

University of Minho & HASLab

Jul 2017 – Mar 2020 | Braga, Portugal

Senior Researcher in Interactive Systems

- Conducted scientific research on interactive systems, user interface patterns, and formal methods for software verification.
- Published peer-reviewed papers on system correctness, software architecture patterns, and complex human-computer interaction frameworks.

University of Minho

Sep 2014 – Mar 2020 | Braga, Portugal

Invited Assistant Professor

- Lectured undergraduate and master's courses in Software Engineering, Object-Oriented Programming, and

System Design.

- Mentored master's students in software architecture, design patterns, and interface usability principles.

FEATURED PORTFOLIO CASE STUDIES

Case 01: Multi-Tenant Enterprise Custom Delivery Pipelines

ALM / Architecture

Led systems thinking and end-to-end UX design to enable big enterprise customers with distinct business lines to configure custom release pipelines. Mapped deep technical platform layers to intuitive UI controls.

Case 02: Enterprise Identity & External IdP Integration

Identity / Security

Designed seamless, multi-tenant authentication journeys for enterprise customers integrating external Identity Providers (OIDC/SAML). Unblocked major enterprise sales cycles and reduced support overhead.

Case 03: Platform Extensibility via Public APIs & Governance

Developer Platform

Architected the end-to-end management UI for public API credentials and granular RBAC permissions. Enabled third-party tool integrations, unblocking automated customer pipelines and increasing platform usage.

Case 04: AI Feedback Assistant & Clustering Tool

Agentic AI / Automation

Pitched, architected, and designed an internal AI-powered intelligence tool to process customer feedback. Automated feedback ingestion and clustering, accelerating discovery synthesis across R&D teams.

EDUCATION, CERTIFICATIONS & HONORS

- **Ph.D. in Computer Science / Informatics** — University of Minho (2012 – 2017) | *Dissertation: Pattern-Based Software Development*
- **Nielsen Norman Group (NN/g):** Certified in *Leading Highly-Effective UX Teams & Management Strategies for UX Managers*
- **OutSystems Top Performer Award (2020):** Recognized in the top 1% of contributors across global R&D.
- **OutSystems Open Days Hackathon Winner (2024):** "Lab Rat" award for innovative internal AI tooling.